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Mine Dump Bid Refused

Ecology Guards Win Round

By DON VIPOND

William Venables, the provincial director of pollution control, has rejected an application from a mining company to discharge up to a million gallons of effluent a day into Juan de Fuca Strait near Jordan River.

Venables' office said this morning that letters advising of the decision had been mailed Monday to the company, Dison Development Ltd., and other interested parties.

The application had been opposed by Jordan River residents, conservationists, recreationists, commercial fishermen and others.

Venables was out of town today and could not be reached but James McCrossen, public relations officer in the pollution control branch, said th decision followed consideration of recommendations from two other government departments — recreation and conservation and health services and hospital insurance.

While those recommendations are confidential, the fact they are referred to specifically suggests both departments opposed the Dison application.

Venables made his decision after considering the company's case, points made by bonafide objectors and reports from his own staff.

The operation at stake was resurrection of the old Cowichan copper mine, which intermittently between 1962 and 1968 dumped mine tailings off a shoreline cliff, half a mile from the community of Jordan River.

Critics say wave and tidal action polluted nearby beaches.

Dison had proposed carrying the tailings by pipe 600 feet farther east where there were stronger currents and discharging them from an outlet just below the low-tide line.

Charles Campbell Jr., general manager of Dison, said he had received no word on the application when reached in Vancouver this morning. He declined any comment.

Dison has already spent about $500,000 in rehabilitating the mine. In an interview last month Campbell said he is against an alternative method of tailing disposal — settling ponds — because the terrain would necessitate putting them on or adjacent to B.C. Hydro right of way to the Jordan River community.

VOTE DISTRIBUTION IN BYELECTIONS

BRANT (L 3,695)	
Derek Blackburn (NDP)	17,043
Robert McIntosh (L)	12,830
Emory Knill (PC)	9,477
Alcide Hamelin (SC)	323
CENTRAL NOVA (PC 7,221)	
Elmer MacKay (PC)	15,559
Clarrie MacKinnon (L)	11,176
Allan Marchbank (NDP)	1,940
John Henderson (SC)	698
CHAMBLY (L 16,028)	
Yvon L'Heureux (L)	16,285
Emile Boudreau (NDP)	5,175
Leopols Hamel (PC)	1,588
Jean McGlynn (Ind L)	1,060
Claude Longtin (Ind)	412
TROIS-RIVIERES (L 7,085)	
Claude Lajoie (L)	11,902
Real Lemay (SC)	10,876
Therese-M. Landry (PC)	1,711
Henri-G. Grenier (Ind)	419
Joseph Thibodeau (Ind)	157

★ ★ ★

Liberals Hold Two Ridings

Times News Services

The Liberal party retained two seats and lost one to the New Democrats and the Conservatives held another in four federal byelections Monday which gave everyone something to cheer about.

ALL CHARGES of tax evasion and falsifying income tax returns were dismissed today against Victoria lawyer-businessman David Hummel. See story on Page 17.

But the byelections gave little indication of a major trend in voter commitments in a time of harsh criticism of federal economic policies.

The Liberals retained Chambly and Trois-Rivieres in Quebec, lost Ontario's Brant riding to the NDP and managed to reduce the Conservative majority in Central Nova in Nova Scotia.

The new MPs will be: Derek Blackburn, NDP—Brant; Elmer MacKay, PC—Central Nova; Yvon L'Heureux, L—Chambly, and Claude Lajoie, L—Trois-Rivieres.

The results were not surprising and reactions from winners and losers were predictable.

VIEWS DIFFER

Brant had been touted by political pundits as being most representative of the national temper in relation to Prime Minister Trudeau's economic policies. The opposition parties were quick to say these policies had been rejected. The Liberals said the loss resulted from local circumstances.

Central Nova involved the personal prestige of Robert Stanfield, national Conservative leader and a former Nova Scotia premier. Mr. MacKay, his personal choice as candidate, held off an all-out Liberal assault, but his decreased majority was

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